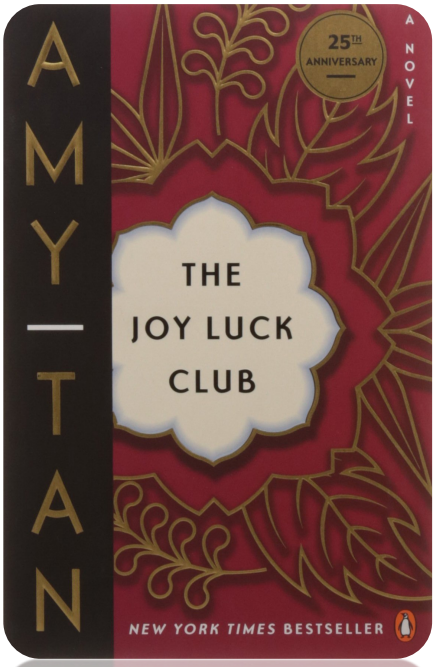
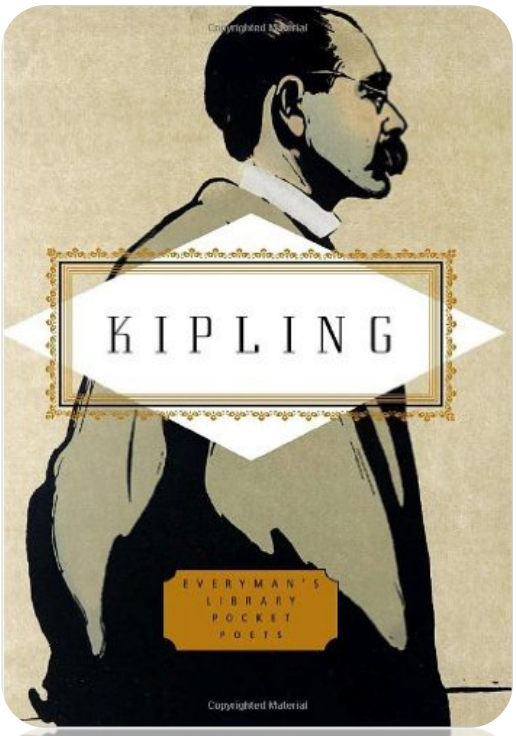
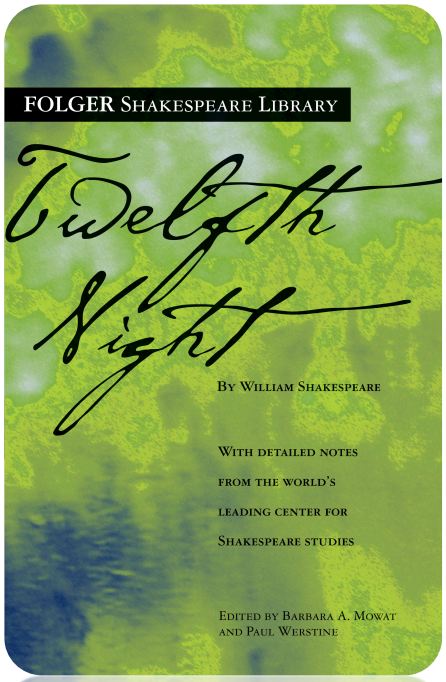
UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

Literary Criticism

Regional • 2017







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Region • 2017

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. A term coined by the Roman Catholic Church and applied to much contemporary writing, particularly with reference to the use of experimental forms is
   A) postmodern.
   B) quadrivium.
   C) semiotics.
   D) *terribilità*.
   E) trivium.

2. Drama that presents a view of the ridiculousness and ludicrousness of the human condition through its abandonment of the usual or rational devices and by its use of nonrealistic form is known as (a)
   A) Theater of Cruelty.
   B) Theater of the Absurd.
   C) tragedy of blood.
   D) tragicomedy.
   E) well-made play.

3. A name frequently applied to the last half of the eighteenth century in England, resulting from historians' seeing the interval between 1750 and 1798 as a seed field for emerging romantic qualities in literature, is the
   A) Age of Johnson.
   B) Age of Sensibility.
   C) Early Restoration Period.
   D) Early Victorian Period.
   E) Late Victorian Period.

4. The Japanese filmic cartoon genre characterized by extreme stylization and asymmetrical design is
   A) anime.
   B) haiku.
   C) kabuki.
   D) manga.
   E) senryu.

5. The author of *The Pearl*, *The Red Pony*, *The Winter of Our Discontent* and recipient of the 1940 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for *Grapes of Wrath* is
   A) John Cheever.
   B) William Faulkner.
   C) John Hersey.
   D) Larry McMurtry.
   E) John Steinbeck.

6. The words or acts of a character that carry a meaning unperceived by the character but understood by the audience comprise
   A) ambiguity.
   B) catharsis.
   C) dramady.
   D) dramatic irony.
   E) understatement.

7. The group of Renaissance writers who favored the introduction of heavy Latin and Greek words into the standard English vocabulary is known as the
   A) Ciceronians.
   B) Geneva School.
   C) Inkhornists.
   D) Parnassians.
   E) *Pléiade*.

8. In its figurative sense, the special usage of a word or words, often without the conscious knowledge of the author or reader, in which there is a change in the word's or words' basic meanings is
   A) denotation.
   B) diction.
   C) digression.
   D) imagery.
   E) plain style.

9. **Not** among the several stages or processes delineated in Freytag's Pyramid is the
   A) catastrophe.
   B) climax.
   C) complication(s).
   D) exposition.
   E) relief scene.

10. A pause or break in a line of verse, which in classical poetry usually occurs near the middle of a line, is (the)
    A) cadence.
    B) caesura.
    C) chiasmus.
    D) elision.
    E) enjambment.

11. The group of American writers, including Ida Tarbell, Lincoln Steffens, and Upton Sinclair, who between 1902 and 1911 worked to expose the dishonest methods and unscrupulous motives in big business and in city, state, and national government is

A) the Agrarians.
B) The Fugitives.
C) the Hartford Wits.
D) the Lost Generation.
E) the Muckrakers.

12. The incompleteness of the last foot of a line of poetry, specifically truncation by omission of one or two final syllables, is known as

A) acatalexis.
B) anacrusis.
C) catalexis.
D) homeoarchy.
E) homeoteleuton.

13. **Not** among North American women known for their twentieth-century poetry is

A) Maya Angelou.
B) Margaret Atwood.
C) Elizabeth Bishop.
D) H. D.
E) Emily Dickinson.

14. The eighteenth-century Irish novelist who wrote *The Life and Opinions of Tristam Shandy, Gentleman,* and *A Sentimental Journey through France and Italy* and whose influence can be seen in the writing of James Joyce and David Foster Wallace, among others, is

A) Daniel Defoe.
B) Henry Fielding.
C) Samuel Richardson.
D) Laurence Sterne.
E) Jonathan Swift.

15. A narrative or tradition handed down from the past that is characterized by having something of the historical truth and relatively little of the supernatural is called (a/an)

A) anecdote.
B) folklore.
C) legend.
D) myth.
E) parable.

16. The American novelist, playwright, and co-founder of the first modern American theater company, whose play *Alison's House,* inspired by Emily Dickinson's life, earned her the 1931 Pulitzer Prize for Drama is

A) Zoë Akins.
B) Ketti Frings.
C) Zona Gale.
D) Susan Glaspell.
E) Beth Henley.

17. The authors Paul Laurence Dunbar, Gwendolyn Brooks, Langston Hughes, Toni Morrison, Ralph Ellison, and Alice Walker represent the body of

A) African-American literature.
B) Irish literature.
C) Jewish-American literature.
D) Scottish literature.
E) Welsh literature.

18. An illustrative story teaching a lesson that in its true intent and form parallels an allegory is a

A) fable.
B) fairy tale.
C) *Märchen*.
D) parable.
E) sketch.

19. The term borrowed from painting and applied to the highly personal manner of writing in which an author presents materials as they appear to an individual temperament at a precise moment and from a particular vantage point rather than as they are presumed to be in actuality is known as

A) aestheticism.
B) cultural primitivism.
C) existentialism.
D) expressionism.
E) impressionism.

20. The type of lyric poem that is characterized by its single, unified strain of exalted feeling and style, by its single purpose, and by its dealing with one theme is the

A) aubade.
B) elegy.
C) hymn.
D) limerick.
E) ode.

21. A figure of speech used for so long that it is taken in its denotative sense only, without the conscious comparison to a physical object it once conveyed, is known as a(n)

A) archaism.
B) dead metaphor.
C) false etymology.
D) hobson-jobson.
E) silent correction.

22. The eponymic term for an expression, often involving a pun, that gives a literal sense to a figurative statement, such as "'Simply remarkable,' said the teacher when asked her opinion about the new dry-erase board," is

A) Gongorism.
B) malapropism.
C) Marinism.
D) Spoonerism.
E) Wellerism.

23. The poet and author of *The Bell Jar* who received, posthumously, the 1982 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry is

A) Carolyn Kizer.
B) Lisel Mueller.
C) Mary Oliver.
D) Sylvia Plath.
E) Anne Sexton.

24. The twentieth-century Nigerian (British Commonwealth) author of *Things Fall Apart*, *No Longer at Ease*, and *Arrow of God* is

A) Chinua Achebe.
B) J. M. Coetzee.
C) Nadine Gordimer.
D) Wole Soyinka.
E) Derek Walcott.

25. The term applied to the group of twentieth-century writers in the American South who published the little magazine *The Fugitive*, which championed Southern regionalism, and who founded the New Criticism movement is

A) Agrarians.
B) Hartford Wits.
C) Lollards.
D) Lost Generation.
E) Muckrakers.

26. The immensely successful twentieth-century British author of *The Moon and Sixpence*, *Of Human Bondage*, *The Razor's Edge*, *Catalina*, *The Narrow Corner*, and *Cakes and Ale* is

A) William Golding.
B) Rudyard Kipling.
C) W. Somerset Maugham.
D) Bertrand A. W. Russell.
E) George Bernard Shaw.

27. **Not** among the poets of England's nineteenth-century Romantic Period whose poetry offers a romantic view of nature, espouses an organic concept of art, and places the individual as the center of art is

A) Samuel Taylor Coleridge.
B) John Keats.
C) Rudyard Kipling.
D) Percy Bysshe Shelley.
E) William Wordsworth.

28. Poetry in which the stanzas are linked through some pattern of repetition is known as

A) chain verse.
B) echo verse.
C) free verse.
D) nonsense verse.
E) skeltonic verse.

29. The term that usually refers to the English- and Latin-language pentameter poetic line having the pattern adjective-noun-adjective-noun is

A) end-stopped line.
B) golden line.
C) pyramidal line.
D) rhopalic line.
E) tagline.

30. The class of literary work specializing in carnage and violence, in the nineteenth century published as dime novels, many examples of which have to do with crime and high emotion, is known as

A) blood and thunder.
B) bob and wheel.
C) cloak and dagger.
D) cloak and sword.
E) storm and stress.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with William Shakespeare's *Twelfth Night, or, What You Will.*
Items 37-42 are associated with Amy Tan's *The Joy Luck Club.*
Items 43-50 are associated with Rudyard Kipling's poetry (selected).

31. In Shakespeare's *Twelfth Night* Viola's declaration to the Captain that she will "serve this duke," continuing in the imperative, "Thou shalt present me as an eunuch to him," is meant to ensure the disguising of

A) her age.
B) her aristocratic rank.
C) her foreigness.
D) her relationship to Sebastian.
E) her voice.

32. The confusion between Toby and Andrew regarding Maria's surname—Andrew's misunderstanding that it is *Accost*—plays nicely against Shakespeare's extensive use in the play of

A) allonyms.
B) heteronyms.
C) nominalism.
D) *redende namen.*
E) xenoglossia.

33. The apostrophe "Disguise, I see thou art a wickedness / Wherein the pregnant enemy does much" is nothing less than Viola rendering the play's

A) theme.
B) thesis.
C) tmesis.
D) treatise.
E) typology.

34. Olivia's comeback to Viola's petitioning on Orsino's behalf, "Have you not set mine honor at the stake, / And baited it with all th' unmuzzled thoughts / That tyrannous heart can think?" is a metaphor whose vehicle is

A) a bear tied to a stake being attacked by dogs.
B) a fishhook in the shape of a heart tied to a stake.
C) a maiden whose honor is threatened by a tyrant.
D) a thoughtless tyrant petitioning an innocent heart.
E) a witch tied to a stake, rifle muzzles pointed at her.

35. Orsino's instruction, "Give me thy hand / And let me see thee in thy woman's weeds," is directed at

A) Feste.
B) Maria.
C) Olivia.
D) Valentine.
E) Viola.

36. The Fool's punny response to Viola's inquiry regarding Olivia's whereabouts, "I would play Lord Pandarus of Phrygia, sir, to bring a Cressida to this Troilus," is a

A) biblical allusion.
B) classical allusion.
C) historical allusion.
D) optical allusion.
E) topical allusion.

37. In Amy Tan's *The Joy Luck Club* the wish that Ying-ying, as a young girl, wanted to share with the Moon Lady and that she could not, for years, remember is that she wished

A) to be American.
B) to be a champion chess player.
C) to be a competent mahjong player.
D) to be a great piano player.
E) to be found.

38. Waverly's mother remembers how "lucky" Waverly was when she "got the chicken pox [. . . and] had to stay home from school"; the subject at hand is

A) medicinal foods.
B) piano recitals.
C) Rich's freckles.
D) tournament losses.
E) visits by the doctor.

39. I "began to cry again, that this was our fate, to live like two turtles seeing the watery world together from the bottom of the little pond." The antecedent of *our* in "our fate" is

A) Lindo and Waverly Jong.
B) An-mei and Rose Hsu Jordan.
C) Ying-ying and Lena St. Clair.
D) Yu and Chwun Hwa Wang Chwun.
E) Suyuan and Jing-mei Woo.

40. **Not** numbered as one of "the anchors of my life [. . .]: Why did *I* have to care for them?" (Rose's brothers) is

A) Bing.
B) Canning.
C) Luke.
D) Mark.
E) Matthew.

41. "I wiped my eyes and looked into the mirror. I was surprised at what I saw. I had on a beautiful red dress, but what I saw was even more valuable. I was strong. I was pure. [. . .]. I was like the wind" summarizes

A) Lena's epiphanic recovery.
B) Lindo's self-assessment.
C) Rose's epiphanic recovery.
D) Suyuan's self-assessment.
E) Waverly's epiphanic recovery.

42. In anticipation of her debut at the piano, what Jing-mei enjoyed practicing the most was the

A) accepting of the first-place award.
B) chromatic scales.
C) fancy curtsy.
D) thematic études.
E) turning of the pages of the sheet music.

Items 43-47 refer to Rudyard Kipling's

Recessional

God of our fathers, known of old,
Lord of our far-flung battle-line,
Beneath whose awful hand we hold
Dominion over palm and pine—
Lord God of Hosts, be with us yet,
Lest we forget—lest we forget!

The tumult and the shouting dies;
The Captains and the Kings depart:
Still stands Thine ancient sacrifice,
An humble and a contrite heart.
Lord God of Hosts, be with us yet,
Lest we forget—lest we forget!

Far-called our navies melt away;
On dune and headland sinks the fire:
Lo, all our pomp of yesterday
Is one with Nineveh and Tyre!
Judge of the Nations, spare us yet,
Lest we forget—lest we forget!

If, drunk with sight of power, we loose
Wild tongues that have not Thee in awe,
Such boastings as the Gentiles use,
Or lesser breeds without the Law—
Lord God of Hosts, be with us yet,
Lest we forget—lest we forget!

For heathen heart that puts her trust
In reeking tube and iron shard,
All valiant dust that builds on dust,
And guarding calls not Thee to guard.
For frantic boast and foolish word—
Thy Mercy on Thy People, Lord!

43. In Rudyard Kipling's "Recessional" the first stanza's "Beneath whose awful hand we hold / Dominion over palm and pine" depicts the range of the British Empire in terms of

A) hyperbole.
B) litotes.
C) metonymy.
D) syzygy.
E) understatement.

44. The referential meaning of the poem's title, "Recessional," is echoed in

A) lines 3-4.
B) lines 7-8.
C) lines 15-16.
D) lines 21-22.
E) lines 25-27.

45. The third stanza's jeremiad points to both Tyre and Nineveh as examples of the "pomp of yesterday," which, despite the speaker's explicitness, constitutes both

A) biblical allusion and literary allusion.
B) classical allusion and literary allusion.
C) classical allusion and topical allusion.
D) historical allusion and biblical allusion.
E) historical allusion and topical allusion.

46. The prophetic tone of the speaker's "celebration" of empire crescendos toward and culminates in line 28's

A) anadiplosis.
B) asyndeton.
C) polyptoton.
D) polysyndeton.
E) synecdoche.

47. Line 17's "Judge of the Nations" is but one example of the persona's use of a(n)

A) epithet.
B) euphemism.
C) expletive.
D) pleonasm.
E) pseudomorph.

Items 48-50 refer to Rudyard Kipling's

NEXT PAGE

The Winners

What the moral? Who rides may read.
When the night is thick and the tracks are blind
A friend at a pinch is a friend indeed,
But a fool to wait for the laggard behind.
Down to Gehenna or up to the Throne,
He travels the fastest who travels alone. 6

White hands cling to the tightened rein,
Slipping the spur from the booted heel,
Tenderest voices cry "Turn again!"
Red lips tarnish the scabbarded steel,
High hopes faint on a warm hearth-stone—
He travels the fastest who travels alone. 12

One may fall but he falls by himself--
Falls by himself with himself to blame.
One may attain and to him is pelf—
Loot of the city in Gold or Fame.
Plunder of earth shall be all his own
Who travels the fastest and travels alone. 18

Wherefore the more ye be holpen and stayed,
Stayed by a friend in the hour of toil,
Sing the heretical song I have made—
His be the labour and yours be the spoil.
Win by his aid and the aid disown—
He travels the fastest who travels alone! 24

48. In his pragmatic if not cynical take on collaboration, "The Winners," Kipling's persona sings the praise of

A) altruism.
B) dandyism.
C) egoism.
D) luminism.
E) surrealism.

49. *Throne* in line 5's "Down to Gehenna or up to the Throne" is a metonymic reference to a(n)

A) eternal reward.
B) game.
C) monarch.
D) raj.
E) toilet.

50. The second stanza, with its specific imagery, speaks especially to the constraints of the

A) cavalryman's life.
B) equestrian life.
C) married life.
D) single life.
E) trooper's life.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-55 refer to Jean Toomer's

November Cotton Flowers

Boll-weevil's coming, and the winter's cold,
Made cotton-stalks look rusty, seasons old,
And cotton, scarce as any southern snow, 3
Was vanishing; the branch, so pinched and slow,
Failed in its function as the autumn rake;
Drouth fighting soil had caused the soil to take 6
All water from the streams; dead birds were found
In wells a hundred feet below the ground—
Such was the season when the flower bloomed. 9
Old folks were startled, and it soon assumed
Significance. Superstition saw
Something it had never seen before: 12
Brown eyes that loved without a trace of fear,
Beauty so sudden for that time of year.

51. Jean Toomer's "November Cotton Flowers" is a

A) caudate sonnet.
B) curtal sonnet.
C) Miltonic sonnet.
D) Petrarchan sonnet.
E) Shakespearean sonnet.

52. The relation between the stanzas comprising Jean Toomer's closed form poem is

A) digression.
B) elision.
C) enjambment.
D) redaction.
E) reduplication.

53. The syzygic line "Significance. Superstition saw" (line 11) is characterized by

A) assonance.
B) cacophony.
C) cross-alliteration.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) sigmatism.

54. The extreme of the comparison that is the third line of the sonnet turns on a(n)

A) allusion.
B) epiphany.
C) paradox.
D) simile.
E) tautology.

55. Toomer's poem depends on Kenneth Burke's four master tropes to convey the desolation wrought by slavery on both the landscape and the spirit; the tone of the closing depiction of superstition's view is

A) abruptly optimistic.
B) refreshingly submissive.
C) surprisingly flippant.
D) unwarrantedly macabre.
E) whimsically apathetic.

Items 56-61 refer to Geoffrey Hill's

In Memory of Jane Fraser

When snow like sheep lay in the fold
And winds went begging at each door,
And the far hills were blue with cold,
And a cold shroud lay on the moor,

She kept the siege. And every day
We watched her brooding over death
Like a strong bird above its prey.
The room filled with the kettle's breath.

Damp curtains glued against the pane
Sealed time away. Her body froze
As if to freeze us all, and chain
Creation to a stunned repose.

She died before the world could stir.
In March the ice unloosed the brook
And water ruffled the sun's hair.
Dead cones upon the alder shook.

56. In Geoffrey Hill's "In Memory of Jane Fraser" the second line's attribution of "begging" to the wind is an example of

A) affective fallacy.
B) empathy.
C) intentional fallacy.
D) pathetic fallacy.
E) transferred epithet.

57. The first stanza of Hill's lyric poem exhibits

A) anaphora.
B) epistrophe.
C) pleonasm.
D) polysyndeton.
E) symploce.

58. The movement that informs the poem's final stanza is set up by images of immobility that, in the first three stanzas, rely on the effective use of

A) hyperbole.
B) litotes.
C) simile.
D) synecdoche.
E) zeugma.

59. Hill's "memory," appealing to the senses, draws the audience's attention past the immobility of the first three stanzas into the movement of the final stanza through

A) chiaroscuro.
B) digression.
C) foregrounding.
D) hendiadys.
E) imagery.

60. The species of balanced pattern that binds the third and fourth lines of "In Memory of Jane Fraser" together is

A) chiaroscuro.
B) chiasmus.
C) hiatus.
D) hypallage.
E) sfumato.

61. The emotively disconcerting description "Her body froze / As if to freeze us all" (lines 10-11) is characterized by

A) antanaclasis.
B) parataxis.
C) pleonasm.
D) polyptoton.
E) symploce.

Items numbered 62 - 65 found on the next page.

Items 62-65 refer to John Updike's

Player Piano

My stick fingers click with a snicker
And, chuckling, they knuckle the keys;
Light footed, my steel feelers flicker
And pluck from these keys melodies.

My paper can caper; abandon
Is broadcast by dint of my din,
And no man or band has a hand in
The tones I turn on from within.

At times I'm a jumble of rumbles,
At others I'm light like the moon,
But never my numb plunker fumbles,
Misstrums me, or tries a new tune.

62. The diction of John Updike's personified speaker in "Player Piano" serves to establish and reinforce the speaker's own necessarily static character through its reliance on

A) concordance.
B) consonance.
C) discordia concors.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) synæthesia.

63. The mechanical nature of the speaker's self-description is accentuated by no fewer than five

A) compound rhymes.
B) internal rhymes.
C) leonine rhymes.
D) masculine rhymes.
E) slant rhymes.

64. The clever rhyming of *melodies* (line 4) with *-le the keys* (line 2) is an example of

A) broken rhyme.
B) chain rhyme.
C) compound rhyme.
D) heteromerous rhyme.
E) macaronic rhyme.

65. The speaker's proud summation, "But never my numb plunker fumbles, / Misstrums me," (lines 11-12) is meaningfully paired with "or tries a new tune," a clear statement of a(n)

A) desire to sing as well as play music.
B) inability to create.
C) need for a tuning software update.
D) repressed fear of ivory.
E) wish to be self-sufficient.

Required tie-breaking essay prompt on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Walt Whitman's "When I Heard the Learn'd Astronomer," and offer a discussion of the several contrasts that support the poem's theme.

When I Heard the Learn'd Astronomer

When I heard the learn'd astronomer,
When the proofs, the figures, were ranged in columns before me,
When I was shown the charts and diagrams, to add, divide, and measure them,
When I sitting heard the astronomer where he lectured with much applause in the lecture-room,
How soon unaccountable I became tired and sick,
Till rising and gliding out I wander'd off by myself,
In the mystical moist night-air, and from time to time,
Look'd up in perfect silence at the stars.

KEY

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line arrows up ➔

1.	A	375
2.	B	2
3.	A or B	9
4.	A	29
5.	E	602
6.	D	155
7.	C	253
8.	D	246
9.	E	211
10.	B	71
11.	E	309
12.	C	76
13.	E	557
14.	D	547
15.	C	269
16.	D	607
17.	A	8
18.	D	349
19.	E	249
20.	E	334
21.	B	130
22.	E	501
23.	D	605
24.	A	584
25.	A	10
26.	C	574
27.	C	
28.	A	81
29.	B	219
30.	A	61
31.	E	1.2.58
32.	D	1.3.54
33.	A	2.2.27
34.	A	3.1.123
35.	E	5.1.285
36.	B	3.1.53
37.	E	83
38.	C	177
39.	B	217
40.	B	123
41.	B	58
42.	C	139
43.	C	298
44.	B	
45.	D	
46.	C	372
47.	A	181
48.	C	
49.	A	
50.	C	
51.	E	442
52.	C	174
53.	E	
54.	D	445
55.	A	
56.	D	356
57.	A	24
58.	C	445
59.	E	246
60.	B	84
61.	D	372
62.	D	337
63.	B	255
64.	D	232
65.	B	

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e,

the Folger Shakespeare *Twelfth Night*,

the Penguin *The Joy Luck Club*,

and to Washington's Kipling collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Walt Whitman's "When I Heard the Learn'd Astronomer"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of the contrast that support the theme of Walt Whitman's "When I Heard the Learn'd Astronomer" include

alliteration,	imagery,	sigmatism,
allusion,	internal rhyme,	speaker,
ambiguity,	inversion,	structure,
anaphora,	metaphor,	style,
asyndeton,	pun,	syncope,
diction,	resonance,	synecdoche,
elision,	rhopalic line,	theme, and
free verse,	setting,	tone.

The young writer in her discussion of the contrasts that inform Whitman's poem should address the poem's theme, which might itself be summed up in terms of contrast: The reduction of the mystery of the universe, as represented by the stars, to proofs and figures and represented further by diagrams and in charts (lines 2-3) fails utterly.

The contestant might argue that the very structure of the poem is a balance in contrast; he might point out that the first four lines, which are grouped through anaphora, contrast with the final four lines, which lose the structured anaphora and exhibit something toward rising, gliding, wandering (line 6).

The anecdotal tone of the speaker's description of the lecture-room contrasts with the ordered nature of such a setting in which the speaker would be sitting, essentially shackled like Plato's prisoners in the cave, until he tires of all that his fellow prisoners applaud (line 4), and he finds his way out of the lecture-room into the "mystical moist night-air" (line 7). The contrast between the imagined stentorian voice of the lecturer punctuated "with much applause" (line 4) and the silence of the open-area night should be central to the discussion.

The young writer might focus on the temporal turn that begins with line 5's "How soon unaccountable [. . .]." She might make something of the poem's diction beyond its characterizing of the poem's speaker (a contrast, certainly, with the learned nature of the lecturer). Inherent in the speaker's use of *unaccountable*, given the contrast between the figures and graphs of the poem's lecture-room and the mystical cosmos, is wordplay, specifically, a pun. She might point to the ambiguity of the phonetic quality of *heard*, which, through its implied homonym *herd*, contrasts with the solitary refuge to which the speaker escapes. A very Whitmanesque contrast is inherent in the dried-ink world of graphic representation (the charts, diagrams, etc.) and the mystical moistness (line 7) of nature.

The contestant might argue that the poem itself is, in its fullness, a metaphor that sings the praise of actually experiencing the world, much in the vein of Wordsworth impugnment of book learnin': "One impulse from a vernal wood / May teach you more [. . .]."